

Vincent Walker

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Senior Full-Stack Engineer with 7+ years building and shipping production Rails applications across healthtech, e-commerce, and marketplace platforms. Specialises in Ruby on Rails, React, and Hotwire, with hands-on experience owning features end-to-end from architecture through to deployment. Comfortable in small, fast-moving teams where engineers take real ownership. Brings an atypical edge: a prior career in pharmaceutical sales developed a commercial instinct that informs how I think about product decisions, not just technical ones. Open to senior full-stack or Rails-focused roles, permanent or contract

TECHNICAL SKILLS

❖ AWS / Heroku ❖ Ruby on Rails ❖ React.js ❖ Stimulus.js ❖ Turbo ❖ Tailwind
❖ Redis / Sidekiq ❖ PostgreSQL ❖ Solid queue ❖ Solid cache ❖ Docker ❖ CI/CD

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- ❖ Engineering Leadership: Rapidly evolved from a self-taught background to architecting complex, production-grade Ruby on Rails applications, demonstrating a high degree of technical adaptability and continuous learning.
- ❖ System Optimisation(Boilerjuice): Engineered a high-performance dynamic site-reporting tool that utilized AWS DynamoDB for real-time data ingestion, directly improving the operational visibility for CS agents and on-site engineers.
- ❖ Architecture & Security (Mercantiworld): Independently architected a full-stack SaaS MVP using Rails 8 and Hotwire integrating multi-provider payment gateways (Stripe/Braintree) and AWS (Elastic beanstalk, S3, Lightsail). Verified system resilience through rigorous smoke and stress testing to ensure production readiness
- ❖ Global Scaling (Scan.com): Key contributor to the core engineering team that designed and deployed a nationwide B2B scheduling platform for the US market, managing complex multi-portal permissions for Admin, Legal, and Healthcare users.
- ❖ Process Improvement (King & McGaw): Significantly enhanced application stability by implementing automated testing suites, increasing code coverage and reducing regression cycles during the transition to Rails 6.1.

CAREER SUMMARY

CONTRACT SENIOR SOFTWARE ENGINEER – VARIOUS CLIENTS 2026 – Present

- Executing high-impact, short-term engineering projects across Rails and full-stack environments, integrating seamlessly with established production teams and existing codebases.
- Rapidly auditing and navigating complex, unfamiliar architectures to identify and implement critical enhancements across backend architecture, frontend interfaces, and cloud infrastructure.
- Collaborating closely with cross-functional stakeholders to drive technical delivery and achieve specific commercial outcomes within rigorous project deadlines.

FOUNDER & SENIOR ENGINEER- MERCANTIWORLD July 2025 - Present

- Independently designed and launched a Rails 8 + Hotwire e-commerce platform from the ground up, maintaining this as an ongoing personal project while returning to full-time employment.
- Architected scalable AWS infrastructure (Elastic Beanstalk, S3), integrated multi-provider payment gateways (Stripe/Braintree), and validated production readiness through smoke and stress testing.
- Deepened expertise in Rails 8, Solid Queue, Solid Cache, and modern full-stack architecture through end-to-end product ownership.
- Parked active development after 12 months to focus on contract engineering engagements, retaining the platform and codebase for potential future development.

PRODUCT ENGINEER [SCAN.COM](#) (US ENGINEERING TEAM) November 2022 – July 2025

- Core contributor to the ground-up rebuild of Scan.com's US B2B platform, creating role-specific portals for Attorneys, Referring Providers, and Admins, managing complex multi-tier permissions across all user types.

- Pioneered and delivered a first-of-its-kind patient results portal, enabling imaging centres to surface scan results directly to patients via Attorney and Referring Provider-generated access links, with full-stack ownership across Rails backend and React/Hotwire frontend.
- Built to support an estimated 5,000 users across an initial Georgia market rollout, with architecture designed to scale nationally.
- Collaborated on a new software assessment tool for Traumatic Brain Injury (TBI), a sensitive, high-stakes clinical context requiring careful attention to data integrity and user experience.

FULL STACK RUBY ON RAILS DEVELOPER – BOILERJUICE *July 2021 – November - 2022*

- Built a dynamic field data capture tool used by on-site engineers (primarily on iPad) to record heating oil tank inspections, capturing tank type, customer details, and dip measurements for new and existing customers.
- Owned full-stack delivery across Rails backend, Postgres storage, and a responsive frontend built to work reliably in field conditions.
- Extended the existing AWS DynamoDB integration to sync form submissions in real time, giving the CS team live visibility of field data across Boilerjuice's multi-system infrastructure.

RUBY ON RAILS DEVELOPER – KING AND MCGAW *February 2021 – July 2021*

- Delivered frontend improvements across core e-commerce journeys including product pages, search, filtering, and checkout, using Rails, Vue.js, and Tailwind CSS.
- Expanded RSpec test coverage from 40% to 85%, significantly reducing production bugs and improving codebase confidence.
- Left having been offered a full-stack role at Boilerjuice, concluding a fixed-term contract.

BUSINESS SYSTEMS DEVELOPER- HOSTELLING INTERNATIONAL *June 2019 - November 2020*

- First professional engineering role, focused on improving frontend user experience across hihostels.com using Ruby, HTML, CSS, and JavaScript.
- Gained early exposure to a Padrino-based Ruby backend, building foundational skills that led directly to a Rails developer role.

EARLIER CAREER

PHARMACEUTICAL SALES *(2004 – 2019)*

- GSK Vaccines (12 years): Managed the Travel Vaccine portfolio across South London, growing revenue 4-5% year-on-year in a declining market.
- Subsequent roles at Aymes Nutrition and earlier positions in medical sales before transitioning into software engineering in 2017.

EDUCATION

Diploma in Sales Management - *Damelin College, South Africa*

Secondary School - *Damelin College, South Africa*